



AMSA Safety Alert

Extension National Law certificates of competency—further arrangements for COVID-19

The purpose

The purpose of this Domestic Commercial Vessel (DCV) Safety Alert is to advise vessel owners, operators, masters, and crews that the Australian Maritime Safety Authority (AMSA) has taken steps to allow holders of National Law certificates of competency and first aid certificates to continue to perform their duties even if their certificate expires during the period between 26 March 2020 and 31 January 2021.

Implementation

During this time of uncertainty that has been caused by COVID-19, AMSA has taken a pragmatic approach to seafarer certification.

As a result, AMSA has issued [Exemption 42 Marine Safety \(Extension of time – certificates of competency\) Exemption 2020 \(No. 2\)](#) and [Exemption 43 Marine Safety \(Extension of time – first aid and crewing\) Exemption 2020 \(No. 2\)](#).

These exemptions effectively:

- enable the holder of a National Law certificate of competency, endorsement or first aid certificate, that expired between 26 March 2020 and 31 July 2020, to continue performing duties for a period of 12 months from the expiry date noted on the certificate;
- enable the holder of a National Law certificate of competency, endorsement, or first aid certificate that expires between 1 August 2020 and 31 January 2021, to continue to perform duties until 31 July 2021; and

- permit owners of vessels to crew their vessels with individuals who are subject to these exemptions.

There is no requirement for a vessel owner, operator or seafarer to make application to AMSA for the above measures to apply.

These arrangements apply to certificates of competency issued by the National Regulator, including those issued by AMSA or a state/territory based maritime safety agency that was a delegate of the National Regulator when the certificate was issued.

The arrangements also apply to first aid certificates.

Individuals must continue to comply with any conditions that applied to their expired certificates during the exemption period.

Renewal of certificates of competency

Those individuals who meet the [eligibility requirements for renewal](#), and have the ability to make an application before the expiry date of their certificate, are strongly encouraged to [apply to renew their certificate](#) before it expires, or as soon as practicable after that date.

More information

Should you require any further assistance or information, please contact AMSA Connect on 1800 627 484, +61 2 6279 5000 or via email to AMSAConnect@amsa.gov.au

Copyright © 2020 Australian Maritime Safety Authority, All rights reserved.

You are receiving this email because you have opted in to receive regular updates from the Australian Maritime Safety Authority.

Our mailing address is:

Australian Maritime Safety Authority
82 Northbourne Avenue
Braddon, ACT 2612
Australia

Want to change how you receive these emails?

You can [update your preferences](#) or [unsubscribe from this list](#).

